Relationship Intelligence Master Guidebook

Differences Between Men and Women in Relationships

This guidebook is a working sourcebook for the Relationship Intelligence app. It is not a transcript archive, a clinical manual, or a diagnosis tool. It uses video transcripts, research summaries, and the app's coaching framework as interpretive source material, then cross-checks the strongest claims against relationship science, mate-preference research, personality research, and sexual-outcome research.

The central premise is simple: men and women are not interchangeable in dating and relationships, but they are also not cartoons. Average sex differences can matter in courtship, sex, safety, status, contribution, resentment, family formation, and conflict repair. Individual variation is still large, so the app should use these patterns as hypotheses to test against behavior, not as verdicts.

Sources Used

This guide draws from transcript notes and research summaries associated with Louise Perry, Mary Eberstadt, Freya India, Joyce Benenson, John and Julie Gottman, Alison Armstrong, Suzanne Venker, Tracy Vaillancourt, Dani Sulikowski, Orion Taraban, Kait Willett, and broader relationship-science and mate-preference research. It also incorporates the female-thinker framework developed in the young women's guide: Brene Brown on clarity and boundaries, Susan David on emotional agility, Bell Hooks on female self-love and solitude, Esther Perel on safety and erotic aliveness, Kristin Neff on self-compassion, Tara Brach on accepting inner experience without accepting mistreatment, Carol Dweck and Angela Duckworth on growth and sustained devotion, Lisa Feldman Barrett on emotion and body regulation, and Sonja Lyubomirsky on ordinary repeated connection.

The source material is treated as interpretive input, not as scripture. The strongest ideas are converted into coaching principles, checked against observed behavior, and used to help the app distinguish attraction, safety, respect, contribution, repair, peer pressure, sexual pacing, and long-term compatibility. The newer guidebook structure adds one editorial rule: lead with a concrete story, then explain the research, then translate the claim into app behavior. Users should feel understood before they feel analyzed.

Chapter 1: The Core Map

Example Story

Evan met Claire at a friend's birthday dinner in late spring. He is thirty-two, steady, a little too conscientious, and newly serious about dating after years of keeping things casual. Claire is twenty-nine, funny, socially graceful, and recently out of a two-year relationship with a man she says was "safe but deadening." Their first three dates are good in the obvious ways: she laughs easily, leans in when he talks, texts him pictures from her day, and tells him she likes how calmly he plans things.

By the fourth week Evan notices a pattern he cannot quite name. Claire is warm when he entertains her, compliments her, drives across town, chooses the restaurant, and keeps the emotional temperature light. But she rarely helps make the plan easier. She does not ask much about the work deadline he keeps mentioning, does not offer a real alternative when she cancels, and seems most animated when the date feels like an experience being provided for her. He tells himself not to be needy. She tells herself she is finally dating a man who makes things easy.

The relationship still has real promise. Evan likes her tenderness with children, her curiosity about art, and the way she remembers small details about his family. Claire likes that Evan is not chaotic, not crude, and not trying to rush sex to prove something. But the first quiet fault line is opening: he is measuring her attraction, while the better question is whether her attraction is becoming participation. If he keeps escalating attention while receiving only passive enjoyment, the relationship may train both of them into the wrong roles before either one has done anything obviously wrong.

The cliff hanger for the coach is this: should Evan ask for reassurance, ask for help, pull back, or keep providing until her investment appears on its own?

The app should teach users to separate five questions that often get fused together:

1. Is there attraction?
2. Is there safety?
3. Is there respect?
4. Is there reciprocal contribution?
5. Is there a shared life path?

Modern dating often treats these as one question: "Do they like me?" That is too thin. Someone can like you and still be unsafe. Someone can be safe and still not inspire desire. Someone can desire you and still not respect you. Someone can respect you and still not want your life. Someone can say all the right words and still not contribute when the relationship asks for ordinary sacrifice.

The app's coach should therefore avoid one-size-fits-all advice. It should ask what kind of problem the user is facing: early attraction, selection, reciprocity, digital loyalty, social rivalry, sex pacing, public respect, information diet, repair, or long-term role design.

App Rule

Do not ask only, "Is this person attracted?" Ask, "What behavior is this dynamic rewarding?"

Coach Rules

- Start with the user's actual situation before applying any theory.
- Require role, target, stage, and situation type when possible.

- Separate attraction, safety, respect, reciprocity, and shared-life fit.
- Detect when the chosen category does not match the user's text.
- Be willing to say: this is not a dating-strategy issue; this is safety, repair, values, or life grounding.

Chapter 2: What Women Say They Want vs. What They Respond To

Example Story

Marcus is twenty-seven, average-looking in the honest way most men are: decent face, improving body, not yet impressive enough that the room rearranges around him. He works in operations for a medical-device company, pays his bills, has a small group of loyal friends, and has recently started taking dating seriously because he is tired of being "the nice guy women process their feelings with before choosing someone else." He is not bitter yet, but he can feel bitterness becoming available to him.

On paper Marcus thinks he is offering what women say they want. He is kind, loyal, emotionally available, funny once he relaxes, and genuinely interested in a woman's inner life. On dates, though, he often leads with those traits as if they should create attraction by themselves. He overexplains that he is safe. He gives reassurance before it has been earned. He makes himself endlessly available, then feels confused when women enjoy him but do not seem pulled toward him. After one woman tells him he is "such a good person" and then goes back to a less reliable ex, Marcus asks the app the question he is embarrassed to say out loud: "What do women actually respond to?"

The answer should not humiliate him. It should not tell him to become cruel, unavailable, or performatively dominant. The answer should help him see the missing layer: kindness and loyalty matter most when they are attached to visible self-command. A woman may sincerely admire warmth, but attraction often asks a prior question: does this man have direction, status in some context, embodied confidence, standards, and a life that would feel meaningful to enter?

Marcus's next move is not to stop being kind. It is to stop using kindness as a substitute for capacity. He needs to become clearer, fitter, more socially legible, less approval-seeking, and more willing to let reciprocal effort matter. The cliff hanger is whether he can make that shift without letting resentment recruit him into contempt.

A recurring claim from Orion and Kait is that stated preferences are not the same as revealed attraction. Women may sincerely say they want kindness, safety, loyalty, and emotional availability. Those traits matter. But in live romantic choice, they often matter most when they are attached to a man who already registers as attractive, competent, directed, socially legible, and self-respecting.

This should not be reduced to "women lie." A better interpretation is:

- People are often poor reporters of what produces attraction in real time.
- Stated ideals are usually moral and conscious.
- Attraction is embodied, comparative, status-sensitive, and context-sensitive.
- Long-term satisfaction still requires kindness, reliability, responsiveness, and repair.

Men can also be poor reporters of what they want. A man may say he wants a low-drama, loyal, kind woman, but repeatedly pursue novelty, beauty, sexual access, status, or women who make him feel temporarily powerful. The app should therefore treat stated preference as one layer of evidence for both sexes. It should ask what the person moves toward, rewards, protects, and sacrifices for when desire is present.

The correction is not for men to become cruel or manipulative. The correction is for men to stop offering only niceness, attention, and emotional availability while hiding their direction, standards, capability, and life structure. Alison Armstrong's useful female-side language also belongs here: many men respond strongly to confidence, passion, radiance, and receptivity. Those words should not be used as a script for women to perform helplessness. They point to a broader polarity pattern: a woman who is pleased, alive, responsive, and clear about what works for her often gives a good man

better information than a woman who is only evaluating, correcting, or withholding.

Clinical / Research Support

Mate-preference work across cultures finds both overlap and sex differences. Buss's 37-culture study found that both men and women value kindness and intelligence, while women more often weight resource/status cues and men more often weight physical attractiveness cues in long-term mate selection. Walter, Conroy-Beam, Buss, and colleagues later replicated sex differences in mate preferences across 45 countries, again finding robust average differences around attractiveness and resources while also showing that culture and ecology affect the size and expression of those differences.

Buss and Shackelford's "Attractive Women Want It All" adds another app-relevant layer: women with higher mate value may be more selective across multiple clusters at once - good genes, investment, parenting, and emotional commitment. This helps explain why the app should not tell a man to maximize only one variable. Being nice without attractiveness, attractive without reliability, reliable without direction, or directed without warmth can all fail in different ways.

Kait's app-relevant point maps onto a broader research problem: ideal-partner preference lists do not always predict actual partner choice as strongly as people assume. The coach should therefore ask for behavior: pursuit, relaxation, sexual interest, respect, follow-through, and willingness to enter the other person's life.

Clark and Hatfield's campus sexual-offer studies belong here as a dramatic boundary case. In the classic design, attractive student confederates approached opposite-sex students and asked whether they would go out, come to an apartment, or have sex. Men and women were much more similar around a date than around immediate casual sex; men were far more receptive to the sexual offer. The point is not that men are simple or women are prudish. The point is that context, risk, safety, reputation, and sexual strategy change what the same "interest" signal means.

The phrase "contextual alpha" is useful if it is stripped of internet-posturing. A man does not need to be globally dominant. He needs some context in which his competence, composure, judgment, and social value are visible. A musician can have it on stage, a father can have it with his children, a builder can have it on a job site, a faithful man can have it in a church community, and a quiet man can have it when he handles a hard moment without collapsing. Attraction often needs to see a man in motion, not only hear his self-description.

Rules for a Man Dating a Woman

Ask:

- Is my life legible enough to enter?
- Am I offering only attention, sex, and entertainment?
- Have I made one clear invitation?
- Am I rewarding weak reciprocity?
- Does she respect my time, public dignity, and standards?

Do:

- Make clean bids.
- Stay composed.
- Show direction through behavior.
- Let reciprocal effort affect access.
- Keep kindness attached to standards, direction, and self-command.

Avoid:

- Overexplaining.
- Chasing chronic ambiguity.
- Becoming the unconditional option.
- Treating bitterness as insight.
- Calling every female hesitation manipulation.

Chapter 3: What Men Need But Often Do Not Say Cleanly

Example Story

Anna asks Ben to hang the television in the living room before her sister visits. They have been together for three years, long enough that their fights have a familiar shape. Ben is thirty-four, a union electrician, physically tired most nights, proud of doing real work with his hands, and not especially verbal when he is embarrassed. Anna is thirty-one, sharp, ambitious, and used to running her life at a high standard. She loves that Ben is steady and capable, but she also carries a private fear that loving a practical, patient man means accepting a life that is less polished than the one she imagined.

Ben hangs the TV on Sunday afternoon before leaving for a long Monday shift. It is not perfect. The mount is safe, the wall is patched, and the room is usable, but the screen is slightly crooked and a few inches off from where Anna wanted it centered. When Ben gets home after ten hours in work boots, Anna meets him at the door with the verdict already loaded. "The TV is crooked. It is off center. Why did I even ask you to do anything if I could have done it better myself or paid someone?" Then she says the line that lands like contempt rather than frustration: "Do I need to lower my standards to be in a relationship?"

Ben does not yell. That is part of the problem. He gets quiet, looks at the wall, says he will fix it later, and disappears into the shower. Anna thinks she has named a standard. Ben hears that his effort, fatigue, usefulness, and masculine pride are worthless unless the final product meets her internal spec on the first try. The next time she asks for help, he will remember the doorframe, the boots, the crooked TV, and the feeling that trying made him smaller.

Across the street, a different couple is running a different system. Leila is not softer because she lacks power. She is the opposite: a founder's daughter who turned a small luxury-events company into a regional brand, dresses like she understands beauty as a civic duty, and has the kind of social presence that makes other women quietly adjust their posture. Her husband, Mateo, is a calm orthopedic PA who restores old motorcycles on weekends, trains jiu-jitsu badly but faithfully, and is patient in a way that comes from competence rather than passivity.

Mateo also hangs things imperfectly. The difference is what Leila does with the imperfection. When he builds shelves for her studio and one bracket sits a little low, she first sees the gift: he used his Saturday, solved the heavy part, and made her workroom more functional. She touches his shoulder and says, "This already makes the room better. Thank you for handling the hard part." Later, when the appreciation has landed, she adds, "Before we call it done, can we level that left bracket? I want the room to match the quality of your work."

That is not subjugation. Leila has not lowered her standard, hidden her eye, or pretended crooked is straight. She has sequenced the relationship correctly: recognize contribution, preserve dignity, then refine the outcome. Mateo feels useful rather than managed. Leila gets a better room and a husband who is more likely to volunteer his strength again. Their exchange lights both of them up because it meets needs on both sides: her need for beauty and competence, his need for respect and meaningful contribution.

The hard diagnostic is whether Anna and Ben are actually practicing love or merely transacting resentment, usefulness, security, sex, rent, and attachment under the word "relationship." Orion's harsh frame is useful here: a relationship is a medium where value is exchanged under rules, definitions, and compromises. Love may exist, but it does not cancel the transaction. If the exchange repeatedly humiliates one person and never becomes grateful, generous, or repairable, the honest question is not "How do we communicate better?" It is "Are we attached to this arrangement because it is loving, or because it is familiar, useful, and hard to leave?"

The Alison Armstrong layer is useful because it names a male pain point that can otherwise sound petty: men often need to feel respected, useful, trusted, appreciated, and not treated as defective women. The app should not teach women to flatter men falsely. It should teach women to understand that appreciation is not decoration; it is part of how many men register that their effort matters.

The women's guide adds a phrase the app should keep: "What this would provide for me is..." Instead of saying only, "I need you to do this," a woman can translate the request into lived benefit: a calmer evening, less decision fatigue, more room to be affectionate, more trust in the home, or more admiration for his leadership. The point is not manipulation or fake sweetness. It is making the connection between his behavior and her lived experience visible.

Men often become resentful when:

- Their contribution is corrected before it is recognized.
- Their initiative is treated as incompetent by default.
- Their need for respect is reframed as ego.
- Their sexuality is treated as crude rather than directional and bond-forming.
- Their attempts to solve problems are mocked instead of translated.
- Their public status is damaged by the partner who is supposed to protect the couple.

The app should also teach men that respect cannot be demanded as tribute. It must be made easy by competent behavior, self-command, fairness, and repair.

The repair is not "men need praise no matter what" or "women should shut up." The repair is sequencing and ownership. Appreciation should not be held hostage by imperfection, but competence should not be excused forever by effort. A strong woman can keep a high standard and still make contribution rewarding. A strong man can receive correction without collapsing when the correction is delivered inside respect rather than contempt.

Rules for Respect and Appreciation

Ask:

- Was contribution recognized before correction?
- Did the correction preserve dignity?
- Is the standard clear before the task begins?
- Does the man have enough competence, ownership, and repair to make respect easy?

Do:

- Say thank you before improving the work.
- Make standards explicit without contempt.
- Protect each other's public status.
- Separate effort, outcome, and ownership.

Avoid:

- Treating male usefulness as disposable.
- Treating correction as proof of superiority.
- Demanding respect without becoming respectable.
- Using appreciation to excuse repeated incompetence.

Chapter 4: The 50-Year Relationship Market

Nate and Julia meet at a birthday dinner in Austin, not on an app, which makes both of them feel like the story is already a little more real. Nate is twenty-eight, works in commercial insurance, lifts before work, and has spent most of his dating life learning how not to look too eager. Julia is twenty-seven, funny, educated, and tired of men who can plan a date but cannot build a relationship. They have three good dates: tacos, a gallery opening, then a Sunday walk that turns into coffee and another two hours of talking.

The chemistry is obvious. The script is not. Nate worries that if sex happens too soon he may feel the chase end before commitment has formed. Julia worries that if she slows it down, he will assume she is not attracted and disappear. Both of them have absorbed a culture that says sex can be casual, independence is safety, options are everywhere, and wanting commitment too openly is needy. Their problem is not only sexual pacing. Their problem is that the social machinery that used to give courtship a shape has been replaced by contraception, apps, delayed marriage, ideology, sexual comparison, peer pressure, economic sorting, and constant digital alternatives.

That is the point of this chapter: casual sex is the ant's-eye view. The wider problem is that men and women are trying to bond inside a market that changed faster than human attachment, status, fertility, jealousy, and family formation could adapt. The user should walk away with a sharper question: is this relationship moving according to shared values, or is it being pulled by the market's default incentives?

Data Panel 1: The Timeline That Changed Courtship

Year	Shift	Relationship consequence
1960	FDA approval of the pill for contraception	Sex becomes more separable from pregnancy, marriage, and family timing.
1969-1970	California creates the first modern U.S. no-fault divorce law	Marriage exit becomes legally cleaner, then spreads nationally.
1971	U.S. fertility falls below replacement for the first time in the modern series	Family formation begins moving away from the old early-marriage model.
1995	Match.com launches	Partner search starts moving from community to database.
2007	iPhone launches	Dating, temptation, pornography, attention, and comparison move into the pocket.
2012	Tinder launches	Romantic opportunity becomes swipeable, gamified, and visibly unequal.
2017-2024	Young women become markedly more liberal than young men	Dating starts carrying more ideological distrust and gender-script conflict.

Data Panel 2: Marriage Moved Later

U.S. Census data show the median age at first marriage rising from about 23.1 for men and 21.1 for women in 1974 to 30.2 for men and 28.6 for women in 2024. This is not a small scheduling change. It means many people now spend a decade or more dating, cohabiting, using apps, building careers, delaying children, and forming sexual habits before marriage is even on the table.

App implication: early dating advice cannot assume a shared marriage script. The coach has to help people create one: pace access, test contribution, name values, and look for evidence of mutual investment.

Data Panel 3: Marriage Became Less Common

NCHS reports that marriage rates were near 10.9 per 1,000 people in 1972, around 10.6 in 1980-1982, and then declined almost steadily until the late 2000s. The current CDC FastStats rate is 6.1 per 1,000 people for provisional 2023 data. Census also reports that 34% of Americans age 15 and older had never been married in 2024.

This matters because every user is not only choosing a person. They are choosing against a culture with less practice at choosing, sustaining, and socially reinforcing marriage.

Data Panel 4: Divorce Peaked, Then Changed Meaning

Divorce rates rose sharply through the 1960s and 1970s and peaked around 1979-1981 by crude-rate measures. More recent CDC data show a much lower divorce rate, about 2.4 per 1,000 population in 2023 among reporting states. That decline is not automatically proof that marriage healed. Fewer and later marriages can reduce the number of divorces while leaving many people stuck in long pre-marital ambiguity.

Michael Rosenfeld's work adds a second point: women initiate roughly 69% of divorces in heterosexual marriages, while nonmarital breakups are much closer to gender-balanced. That suggests marriage itself can become the place where unmet expectations about labor, respect, sex, appreciation, sacrifice, money, and family roles finally become intolerable.

App implication: the app should not ask only "do you love each other?" It should ask whether the durable system is livable: roles, routines, respect, sex, money, children, repair, and gratitude.

Data Panel 5: Sex Did Not Simply Become Easier

Ueda and colleagues found that from 2000 to 2018 sexual inactivity increased among young adults, especially men. In 2016-2018, 30.9% of men and 19.1% of women ages 18-24 reported no sexual activity in the past year; among ages 25-34, the figures were 14.1% for men and 12.6% for women.

So the story is not "everyone is having consequence-free sex." It is more unstable than that: some people are sexually overexposed, some are invisible, some are anxious, some are attached after sex, and some are learning that attention is plentiful but commitment is scarce.

Louise Perry's strongest contribution here is not "be prudish." It is that sexual norms are collective technologies. When a culture teaches young women to override sexual disgust, ignore attachment, suppress the wish for commitment, and call that empowerment, it is often asking women to adapt themselves to the average male short-term mating strategy. Orion's harsher market language makes the complementary point from the other side: sex by itself does not prove love, loyalty, or specialness. It can be meaningful inside a larger exchange, but meaning has to be built by the relationship around it.

Mary Eberstadt adds the intergenerational frame. Her point is not that every modern sexual choice can be judged by old religious dogma. It is that after roughly sixty years of sexual revolution, secular observers can inspect the social results: fewer marriages, more father absence, more unstable bargaining around pregnancy, more single mothers carrying consequences without stable male protection, and more children growing up without a durable model of men and women

keeping an agreement. Her Tupac example from "Papa'z Song" makes the point small enough to feel: the child is not making a policy argument; he is grieving a missing father and the ordinary scene that absence stole from him, someone to play catch with. The coach should remember that sex, commitment, and responsibility are never only private mood states. They build or weaken the world children inherit.

Coach implication: for sex-pacing prompts, the answer should ask what sex is supposed to accomplish. Is it an expression of a bond already forming, an anxious test, a shortcut to commitment, a way to keep someone interested, or a market default the user has not consciously chosen?

Data Panel 6: Apps Changed the Search Field

Pew reported in 2023 that 30% of U.S. adults had used a dating site or app, including 53% of adults under 30. Among online dating users under 30, 79% reported using Tinder. Apps do not merely introduce people. They alter perception: everyone can see alternatives, everyone can be compared, and many users learn to treat ambiguity as normal.

For men, this can create a brutal split between low visibility and overpursuit. For women, it can create abundant attention without reliable selection. Both sexes can come away less trusting, more performative, and worse at converting interest into a shared life.

Data Panel 7: Mental Load Rose With the Dating Market

CDC/NCHS data for 2015-2018 show antidepressant use among adults at 13.2%, with higher use among women than men, 17.7% versus 8.4%. Antidepressant use is not a moral failure and does not prove that dating caused mental distress. But it belongs in the chapter because modern relationships are being formed by people carrying more anxiety, depression, medication, therapy language, trauma vocabulary, and nervous-system load than older courtship scripts anticipated.

App implication: the coach should distinguish a relationship problem from a regulation problem. Sometimes the right move is not another text, another analysis, or another confrontation. It is sleep, body movement, family, faith or values, friends, work, service, place, and a life large enough that romance is not the only scoreboard.

Data Panel 8: Ideology Became Part of Mate Selection

Gallup reports that in 2017-2024, 40% of women ages 18-29 identified as liberal or very liberal, compared with 25% of men ages 18-29. The point is not that one side is good and the other is bad. The point is that young men and women increasingly inherit different moral languages about sex, gender, power, safety, masculinity, feminism, family, and obligation.

Bad feminist scripts can tell women that need, receptivity, motherhood, admiration, or dependence are weakness. Bad red-pill scripts can tell men that affection, service, vulnerability, and female subjectivity are traps. Both scripts make the other sex feel like an enemy class. A serious relationship has to defeat both scripts with lived evidence: goodwill, boundaries, desire, contribution, respect, and repair.

Data Panel 9: Fertility and Family Formation Moved Downstream

Final 2023 birth data show a U.S. total fertility rate of 1,621 births per 1,000 women, below the replacement level of about 2,100. Birth rates among teenagers have fallen dramatically, and women ages 30-34 now have a higher birth rate than women ages 25-29. Again, this is not a command for everyone to marry young or have children. It is evidence that mate selection, commitment, fertility, and adulthood timing are now being negotiated later and under more pressure.

Data Panel 10: The Incentive Map

Pressure	What it rewards	What it damages
Apps	speed, novelty, visual sorting, backup options	patience, repair, embodied community, ordinary compatibility
Casual-sex norms	access before investment, coolness, plausible deniability	sex pacing, trust, female safety, male commitment clarity
Delayed marriage	education, career formation, self-discovery	early family formation, practiced commitment, low-drama selection
Ideological sorting	identity certainty, peer approval, moral signaling	curiosity, charity, sex realism, cross-sex sympathy
Therapy culture	emotional literacy, naming harm, boundaries	behavior change when language becomes endless processing
Red-pill culture	male standards, anti-naivete, attention to incentives	tenderness, trust, female humanity, cooperative family ambition
Pop feminism	female autonomy, anti-abuse language, economic agency	receptivity, admiration, maternal/family desire, respect for male needs

The Useful Claim

This chapter is not saying the pill, feminism, apps, or divorce law single-handedly destroyed relationships. It is saying the combined environment changed the cost-benefit math of courtship. Sex can arrive before contribution. Attention can arrive without care. Autonomy can become isolation. Choice can become paralysis. Therapy words can replace behavior. Ideology can replace direct observation. Men can become passive or resentful. Women can receive attention while struggling to identify who is actually good for them.

The coach should therefore treat casual sex as one visible symptom of a larger market. Before sex, commitment, confrontation, or exit, the user should ask:

- What stage are we actually in?
- Is access increasing faster than trust, contribution, and respect?
- Are we building a shared life or consuming each other for mood regulation?
- Is my advice coming from observation, or from a gender-war script?
- What ordinary behavior would prove this is becoming safer, kinder, more reciprocal, and more real?

The chapter should also keep one humane correction in view: men and women are often suffering from opposite shortages. A woman may have abundant sexual attention and still have very little evidence of commitment, protection, emotional steadiness, or family-minded seriousness. A man may have abundant sexual desire and almost no evidence that he is wanted, chosen, or useful. The app should not let either sex mock the other's problem. It should translate the asymmetry.

Market Rules

Do:

- Give stage-specific advice: early, committed, or mature.
- Treat modern ideology as an information diet and judge it by behavioral output.
- Distinguish real clinical distress from identity loops that keep the user anxious, performative, or dependent on external validation.
- Keep sexual escalation connected to respect, reciprocity, and chosen values.

Avoid:

- Letting the market's default script define the relationship.
- Using sex to prove commitment, desirability, or control.
- Confusing autonomy with isolation.
- Confusing endless options with wisdom.

Example Story: The Decision Point

On the fourth date, Julia invites Nate upstairs. He wants to go. She wants him to want to go. But something in the room feels thin, not because the attraction is weak, but because neither of them knows what the act would mean on Monday.

So Nate does something that would sound corny in an app prompt and brave in real life. He kisses her, slows down, and says, "I like this. I also want it to build in a way that makes us both respect it tomorrow." Julia watches him for a second because she expected either pressure or withdrawal. Instead, she sees direction. The cliff hanger is not whether they have sex. It is whether they can now build the kind of ordinary evidence that makes more closeness feel earned: plans kept, small help offered, gratitude returned, friends met, values named, and desire protected rather than consumed.

That is the repair of the last 50 years in miniature: two people refusing to let the market write the whole script.

Chapter 5: Women as Hunters, Men as Fishermen

Orion's "happy hunting" and "fisherman/hunter" model is useful when softened and made ethical. Men often benefit from creating broad opportunity: build a visible life, make clean invitations, and choose from women who choose back. Women can often benefit from selecting more intentionally rather than letting random male attention decide their dating life.

The young women's guide adds the missing developmental frame: a woman may have the most romantic leverage before she has been taught what that leverage is for. Youth, beauty, warmth, sexuality, and openness can create access, but access is not selection. Attention is not devotion. A man wanting her tonight is not evidence that he is safe, directed, serious, emotionally steady, fertile-minded, family-minded, or capable of building with her.

The coach should therefore treat "How do I find a man?" as a serious selection problem, not a vanity problem. A young woman should not date like a passive consumer waiting to see which man entertains her most. She should date with purpose, like a woman learning to hunt for character without becoming predatory or cold. Trusted women can help her notice what desire can miss: whether a man plans, repairs, respects a no, protects privacy, carries responsibility, and becomes more careful as closeness increases.

For women, "hunting" does not mean chasing men or surrendering standards. It means:

- Know why this specific man interests you before accepting the date.
- Let attraction and respect both matter.
- Show up as a conditional yes: warm if things go well, free to slow down or say no.
- Test character, direction, safety, attraction, and long-term fit.
- Do not use sex, cool-girl availability, or passive attention as commitment shortcuts.

For men, "fishing" does not mean doing nothing. It means:

- Build a life worth entering.
- Make your direction visible.
- Invite clearly.
- Stop trying to convert indifference into devotion.
- Let reciprocal effort affect access.

Example Story

Maya is twenty-two and notices that attention arrives before judgment. Men on apps, at parties, and at work become generous, funny, and brave for ten minutes. For a while this feels like power. Then it starts to feel like noise. She keeps ending up on dates chosen by whoever pursued hardest, not by her own values.

The coach should move Maya from passive screening to intentional selection: "What are three reasons this man is worth learning about? What life is he building? Would you respect becoming closer to that life?" The answer should not shame her for wanting attraction. It should teach her to connect attraction to character, direction, safety, follow-through, family fit, and the version of herself she becomes around him.

Rules for a Woman Dating a Man

Ask:

- Did I choose this man or just react to attention?
- Am I attracted and respectful, or only reassured?
- Does he have direction, character, safety, and follow-through?
- Does he handle my pace and no calmly?
- Am I using sex, cool-girl performance, or passivity to secure commitment?

Do:

- Select intentionally.
- Show up warm when you are a real conditional yes.
- Keep standards visible.
- Watch behavior under desire, inconvenience, and disappointment.
- Choose men by character, direction, safety, attraction, and long-term fit.

Avoid:

- Lazy dating from boredom.
- Outsourcing mate choice to whoever pursues hardest.
- Confusing anxiety with intuition.
- Treating family desire as embarrassing if it is actually your value.
- Ignoring real safety warnings because the chemistry is strong.

The app should also preserve a gentler sentence for young women: there is no shame in sexual inexperience. Sex is not necessary for evaluating whether a man is serious, kind, responsible, honest, protective, or capable of building a life. Early sexual access can sometimes blur the very evaluation the user needs to make. The app should frame restraint as discernment, not fear.

Chapter 6: Contribution, Reciprocity, and the Relationship Opportunity

A major app insight is that attraction is not only chemistry. It is also the perception of a real relationship opportunity. People become more attractive when their lives provide a dignified role for the other person.

For men asking about women, this often means: do not only provide dates, attention, and sex. Create a path for her to participate in your life. Ask for small, appropriate contribution: help choose a plan, bring something, care for a shared problem, remember something that matters, support a real responsibility. Then appreciate it. This is not servitude; it is evidence that she can enter the economy of your life.

For women asking about men, reciprocity means not rewarding vague pursuit while ignoring character. Does he plan? Does he follow through? Does he protect your pace? Does he become more honorable around desire? Does his interest include responsibility?

Example Story

Caleb always picks the restaurant, drives, pays, entertains, and reassures. He never asks for anything. Later he resents that Sophia "doesn't care for him." But he built a dynamic where her only role was receiving. The coach should advise one small dignified ask: "I will handle the plan; help me choose between these two options." Then watch whether participation makes her warmer or resentful.

Reciprocity Rules

Ask:

- Am I asking for contribution in a dignified way?
- Does she become warmer when given a useful role?
- Does he follow through when effort is inconvenient?
- Is one person consuming while the other performs the whole relationship?

Do:

- Invite small contribution.
- Appreciate useful movement.
- Watch whether ordinary cooperation increases respect and attraction.
- Let reciprocal effort affect access.

Avoid:

- Overproviding while secretly expecting repayment.
- Treating help as servitude.
- Turning every ask into a loyalty exam.
- Calling passivity peace when it is really one-way consumption.

Chapter 7: Female Intrasexual Competition and Social Rivalry

Vaillancourt and Dani Sulikowski belong in the guidebook because many users, especially women, may not understand that social pressure from other women can be protective, competitive, anxious, ideological, or status-leveling. The app should not teach paranoia. It should teach discrimination.

Female intrasexual competition often operates indirectly because direct aggression is costly and social belonging matters. The pressure may appear as gossip, exclusion, mockery, reputational framing, sexual shaming, concern, eye-rolling, or advice to become smaller. A woman who becomes visibly attractive, sexually expressive, loved, chosen, competent, or family-oriented may threaten a peer group's identity or status ranking.

Joyce Benenson adds a more precise mechanism: girls and women often compete in ways that are safe, subtle, and solitary. Safe means avoiding direct retaliation. Subtle means the punishment can arrive as tone, facial expression, "concern," reputation leakage, or exclusion rather than open attack. Solitary means a woman may try to improve her position privately, then arrive looking effortless. This is why the app should not treat female peer pressure as merely "jealous friends" or "bad vibes." It may be a whole status ecology.

The newer Sulikowski feminism lens adds a harsher possibility: some ideological scripts may function as mate-restriction behavior, not merely as political opinion. In that frame, a woman is not only competing by becoming more attractive or more chosen. She may also compete by making the rival path look shameful: beauty becomes vanity, receptivity becomes weakness, motherhood becomes a prison, admiration for good men becomes internalized oppression, and masculine competence becomes suspicious rather than desirable. The coach should not turn this into a blanket accusation against every feminist idea. It should use the lens when the practical effect of the advice is to reduce another woman's attractiveness, fertility window, pair-bonding opportunity, respect for men, or confidence in choosing a serious relationship.

Sulikowski's useful warning is that social pressure often arrives with moral cover. A woman may be praised for beliefs or performances that cost other women more than they cost her: contempt for marriage, contempt for male provision, public disgust toward feminine beauty, or status-signaling compassion that mainly trains the group to ignore risk. The coaching question is not "is this feminist?" The coaching question is "what behavior does this script produce, who pays the cost, and does it make love, family, peace, and good mate choice more or less likely?"

This matters for young women because female groups often maintain an equality norm. Publicly standing out can create danger: being prettier, more wanted, more family-oriented, more sexually restrained, more sexually expressive, more successful, more admired by men, or more confident can all invite correction. Sometimes that correction is wise safety feedback. Sometimes it is status regulation dressed as care.

The women's guide adds a key term the app should preserve: gatekeeping the relationship. Gatekeeping does not mean hiding abuse, ignoring real warnings, or isolating from wise people. It means deciding who gets interpretive access to the private world a couple is trying to build. Not every friend deserves the transcript of every fight. Not every anxious text belongs in the group chat. Not every tender moment should become content. A fragile early bond can be ruined if too many outsiders label it before the couple has learned what it actually is.

Good gatekeeping has three doors. The safety door opens quickly when there is intimidation, coercion, cruelty, addiction, serious dishonesty, or escalating control. The counsel door opens to one or two mature people who can tell the truth without feeding drama. The privacy door protects ordinary awkwardness, sexual uncertainty, early repair, and small disappointments long enough for the couple to practice handling them. The coach should teach users to open the right door instead of outsourcing every discomfort to the loudest peer group.

The user should ask:

- Is this advice specific and safety-minded?
- Does it give evidence, or does it mainly create shame?
- Does it protect my life, or keep me acceptable to the group?
- Does it make beauty, motherhood, femininity, admiration, or commitment sound embarrassing without giving me a better life?
- If I obey this advice for five years, do I get more love, peace, family, dignity, and better men, or only more group approval?
- Can these friends celebrate my beauty, commitment, family desire, and good relationship?

Coach responses in this category should use a three-part test:

- Safety evidence: what specific danger are they naming?
- Status evidence: does their advice make me smaller, colder, or less able to choose?
- Life evidence: if I obey them for five years, what kind of relationships and family system become more likely?

Social-Rivalry Rules

Do:

- Separate safety wisdom from peer-status policing.
- Ask whether the advice gives evidence or mostly produces shame.
- Protect relationships from becoming entertainment for the group.
- Keep friends who can celebrate beauty, commitment, family desire, and growth.

Avoid:

- Calling every warning jealousy.
- Treating every group norm as wisdom.
- Letting ideology make love, family, beauty, or good men feel beneath you.

Example Story

Maya likes James because she feels calmer and more feminine around him, not because he makes her small, but because she does not have to perform toughness every second. Then the group chat begins. One friend says he is not exciting enough. Another says Maya is acting like a wife already. A third sends screenshots from a dating podcast about never settling. Nobody says, "I am scared you are leaving the shared single-girl identity we built together." Nobody says, "Your peace makes me compare my own chaos." They say it as jokes, concern, and little comments.

The coach should not tell Maya that all criticism is jealousy. One friend may give concrete safety evidence: "He cancels plans and pressures you sexually." Another may only sneer: "You are becoming boring." The first friend may be protective. The second may be enforcing group norms. The app should teach Maya to separate evidence from social punishment.

Second story: Maya is the first woman in her friend group to get engaged to a stable man who treats her well. At brunch, nobody attacks the relationship directly. They ask if she is "sure," joke that she is becoming traditional, and imply that moving toward marriage means shrinking. Maya should not instantly call them jealous. She should ask a better question: which comments contain evidence about his character, and which comments punish her for leaving the group's shared single identity?

Chapter 8: Public Respect, Digital Loyalty, and Information Diet

Modern relationships are now shaped by audiences: group chats, Instagram, TikTok, DMs, podcasts, and private message threads. A couple can be weakened by third-party attention long before traditional cheating occurs.

Three app categories matter here:

Public Respect

Disagreement is allowed. Public humiliation is different. Correcting, mocking, refuting, or making a partner look foolish in front of others can damage couple status and attraction. The repair is a next-time rule: sensitive corrections happen privately or in a way that protects both people.

Digital Loyalty

The question is not only "Did cheating happen?" The question is whether private attention with outsiders leaks the relationship container. A healthy boundary is not surveillance. It is a clear standard around DMs, flirtation, secrecy, and voluntary transparency.

Information Diet

The app should treat content as behavioral training. Does repeated content make the user more grateful, truthful, kind, loyal, and responsible? Or does it train contempt, suspicion, entitlement, and gender-war reflexes?

Modern feminism's app-relevant error here is not that women should lack autonomy. It is that some online scripts define autonomy as never owing consideration, never needing men, never prioritizing family, never admiring masculine contribution, and interpreting male needs as control. The male equivalent is red-pill ideology that defines masculinity as domination, sexual leverage, contempt, and emotional withholding. Both scripts corrode love.

Freya India's transcript should inform this chapter heavily. Her useful claim is that online-first girlhood turns normal adolescent vulnerability into a market: beauty anxiety, social comparison, therapy language, diagnostic identity, pharmaceutical branding, dating-app ambiguity, and sexual-performance pressure all become content streams. The app should treat this as environmental pressure, not personal weakness. A young woman may believe she is choosing freely while an algorithm is quietly choosing which insecurity becomes her identity.

The women's guide sharpens that into a more usable coaching point: mental health can become another performance standard. A young woman may feel pressure not only to look perfect, but to feel perfectly, explain herself perfectly, use the correct therapeutic language, become optimally regulated, and buy the product, app, coaching program, medication, content stream, or self-improvement plan that promises to make her acceptable. The coach should validate distress without turning every discomfort into an identity or every identity into a purchase funnel.

Susan David's emotional-agility frame belongs here because it gives the app a clean alternative to both repression and emotional obedience. Emotional agility means noticing a feeling, naming it honestly, creating space around it, and choosing behavior from values rather than panic, shame, avoidance, or the need for instant relief. Lisa Feldman Barrett's body-budget frame adds the physiological layer: thoughts and emotions are real internal events, but they are not identity. They are often natural reactions to stimuli, stress, memory, hunger, loneliness, sleep loss, or perceived threat. Before the coach recommends another text, confrontation, diagnosis, or breakup, it should sometimes recommend water, food, sleep, movement, sunlight, a trusted person, and time away from the feed.

The app should therefore ask what an information diet produces in behavior. Does it make a woman more discerning, embodied, resilient, warm, and honest? Or does it make her hypervigilant, performative, contemptuous of men, dependent on peer approval, and unable to tolerate ordinary discomfort? Does it help a man become steadier and more useful, or does it turn grievance into identity?

Public and Digital Rules

Do:

- Protect public respect.
- Treat DMs, secrecy, flirtation, and outside validation as relationship-container questions.
- Judge every information diet by the behavior it trains.
- Keep boundaries voluntary, explicit, and dignity-preserving.

Avoid:

- Phone policing.
- Public humiliation.
- Therapy language as a weapon.
- Content streams that train contempt, suspicion, entitlement, or gender-war reflexes.

Example Story

Olivia consumes content telling her that any expectation from her boyfriend is control. Ryan consumes content telling him that any emotional request from Olivia is manipulation. Their information diets become invisible third partners. The coach should not debate the internet; it should ask what these inputs produce in the relationship.

Second story: Maya wakes up and checks her phone before her feet touch the floor. A beauty video tells her her face shape is wrong. A therapy post tells her discomfort is trauma. A dating clip tells her men are dangerous. Another clip tells her she should be sexually fearless. A friend posts a perfect body. An ad offers a diagnosis. Another ad offers the cure. By noon she has not been harmed by one obvious villain. She has been shaped by a hundred small instructions.

The coaching response should be practical rather than scolding: treat the feed as a teacher and ask what it is teaching. Keep private pain private until a trustworthy person earns access. Do not make a diagnosis into a personality. Let discomfort sometimes be discomfort. Build offline anchors: body, sleep, family, faith or values, work, friends, nature, and service.

Chapter 9: The Feminism Error, Stated Carefully

The guidebook should not caricature feminism. Some feminist corrections were necessary: women needed legal rights, protection from coercion, access to education, political voice, financial agency, and freedom from abusive dependency. The app should never romanticize oppression.

The relationship error comes from a different place: modern pop-feminist dating scripts sometimes import market individualism into intimacy. The result is:

- Autonomy without attachment.
- Equality interpreted as sameness.
- Sexual freedom interpreted as costless symmetry.
- Female empowerment interpreted as never needing, serving, admiring, or choosing a man.
- Male need for respect interpreted as patriarchal entitlement.
- Family desire framed as failure or social surrender.
- Peer approval mistaken for wisdom.
- Career/status maximization treated as the only respectable female life.

The correction is not to tell women to become subordinate. The correction is to restore tradeoffs, embodiment, difference, reciprocity, and values. A woman may want career, beauty, family, freedom, status, travel, sexual exploration, friendship, and spiritual peace. She may not be able to maximize all of them at once. A man may want sex, respect, peace, appreciation, freedom, fatherhood, competence, admiration, and loyalty. He may not be able to receive those while offering no responsibility, direction, emotional discipline, or care.

Freya India's material sharpens the critique: a lot of mainstream empowerment now arrives as consumption. Buy the face, buy the diagnosis, buy the therapy app, buy the sexual identity, buy the career script, buy the public confession, buy the cure for the insecurity that the platform intensified. That is not female liberation in any deep sense. It is often corporate capture of female distress.

Louise Perry adds the sexual norm critique: the post-sexual-revolution story promised that women could adopt male-typical sexual freedom without female-typical costs. Sometimes they can. Often they cannot. Pregnancy risk, reputational double standards, disgust thresholds, attachment, safety risk, and orgasm inequality mean that sexual sameness is not the same as sexual justice.

Sulikowski adds a mate-restriction critique: some feminist messages may be attractive to women not only because they protect against male abuse, but because they also regulate female rivals. A script that tells women to distrust masculine competence, delay or sneer at motherhood, treat beauty as suspect, and interpret admiration for men as subservience can lower the reproductive or relationship success of women who follow it most naively. That does not mean every feminist claim is false. It means the coach should ask what the idea trains a woman to do with actual men, actual family desires, actual sexual risk, and actual peer pressure.

This is especially important because the script can feel morally elevated while making ordinary love harder. A woman may feel righteous calling all male desire entitlement, all protection control, all family orientation surrender, and all feminine effort performance. But if the behavior produced is loneliness, contempt, weaker mate selection, and less capacity to receive good men, the app should name the cost without shaming the user.

Ideology Rules

Ask:

- What behavior does this belief produce?
- Does it increase truth, reciprocity, family formation, responsibility, gratitude, and peace?
- Does it make the other sex easier to understand or easier to despise?

Do:

- Keep the necessary protections of feminism: rights, education, safety, money, voice, and exit from abuse.
- Reject scripts that turn autonomy into loneliness or equality into sameness.
- Reject male scripts that turn standards into domination, contempt, or sexual leverage.

Avoid:

- Confusing peer approval with wisdom.
- Confusing compassion with enabling.
- Confusing difference with oppression.

Better Frame

The question is not "Who wins?" It is "What shared life are these two people building, and what behaviors make that life more likely?"

Chapter 10: Jordan Peterson-Style Responsibility Frame

The app can use a Peterson-style frame without turning the coach into ideology:

- Tell the truth.
- Carry responsibility voluntarily.
- Notice resentment before it becomes contempt.
- Become competent enough to be useful.
- Choose a partner partly by whether you can build something difficult together.
- Do not outsource meaning to romance alone.
- Do not confuse compassion with enabling.
- Do not confuse equality with sameness.

This frame is useful because relationship problems often become abstract moral arguments when they are actually failures of responsibility, truth, and reciprocal sacrifice.

Responsibility Rules

Do:

- Tell the truth.
- Carry responsibility voluntarily.
- Notice resentment before it becomes contempt.
- Become competent enough to be useful.
- Choose a partner partly by whether you can build something difficult together.
- Do not outsource meaning to romance alone.

Avoid:

- Outsourcing your life to grievance.
- Calling every sacrifice oppression.
- Calling every need entitlement.
- Using big moral language to avoid ordinary responsibility.

Example Story

James says his wife is ungrateful. His wife says he never owns the household. A responsibility frame asks: who owns what domain, including noticing, planning, execution, and follow-up? Gratitude cannot replace ownership; ownership cannot erase appreciation.

Chapter 11: Repair and Long-Term Bond Maintenance

The early-dating engine must not erase the long-term relationship engine. In mature relationships, desire, gratitude, sex, repair, responsibility, and admiration must be practiced on purpose. Familiarity will not automatically preserve them.

John Gottman and Julie Gottman are couples researchers and clinicians best known for the "Love Lab," where couples were observed, coded, and followed over time. The famous hook is useful but should not be oversold as magic: the Gottman Institute reports that across seven longitudinal studies, their team predicted divorce with average accuracy over 90 percent using several signals together, including positive-to-negative interaction ratios, physiology, rating dials, oral-history interviews, and the Four Horsemen. For the app, the practical value is not prediction theater. It is pattern recognition.

The Four Horsemen give the repair engine concrete targets. Criticism attacks the person instead of the behavior. Contempt communicates disgust or superiority. Defensiveness refuses responsibility. Stonewalling disappears from the exchange. Contempt deserves special weight because it tells the other person, "I am above you." Public humiliation is contempt with an audience: correcting, mocking, refuting, or making a partner look foolish in front of friends lowers status in the shared world and teaches that closeness may cost dignity.

Long-term repair should ask:

- What happened?
- What did each person hear?
- What need or value was threatened?
- What behavior should change next time?
- What evidence would prove the repair worked?
- What routine makes the new behavior durable?

The app should keep therapy language only if it converts into behavior. Otherwise users get categorization without change.

Long-Term Repair Rules

Do:

- Make behavioral requests.
- Separate appreciation from correction.
- Build routines that preserve desire, gratitude, sex, repair, responsibility, and admiration.
- Track whether repair changes the next similar moment.
- Translate Gottman-style repair into more bids, less contempt, more repair attempts, and a higher ratio of appreciation to correction.

Avoid:

- Endless processing with no behavior change.
- Scorekeeping as the only memory system.
- Treating familiarity as proof that admiration will preserve itself.
- Explaining feelings while leaving the repeated behavior untouched.

Example Story

After ten years, Maria stops thanking Daniel for routine contributions. Daniel withdraws. Maria experiences him as emotionally lazy. He experiences her as entitled. The coach should not only process feelings. It should prescribe a routine: clean appreciation moments, ownership maps, and one weekly repair conversation where changes are measured by behavior.

Chapter 12: Using the Chapter Rules

The rules now live inside the chapters they support. The app should use them as routing instructions rather than as a generic checklist. When the user asks a question, the coach should identify the closest chapter, pull the relevant rules, and then answer in plain English with a next move, a pitfall, a behavior to adopt, and evidence to watch.

Use Chapter 1 when the input is broad or unclear. Use Chapters 2, 5, and 6 for early dating, selection, reciprocity, and attraction. Use Chapter 3 for respect, appreciation, usefulness, and contempt around contribution. Use Chapter 4 for sex pacing, market pressure, stage confusion, ideology, fertility timing, and life grounding. Use Chapter 5 when a woman asks how to date intentionally, choose a man, avoid passive attention, or preserve sexual discernment without becoming cold. Use Chapter 7 for female peer pressure, status policing, gatekeeping, and intrasexual competition. Use Chapter 8 for public respect, digital loyalty, information diet, mental-health performance, emotional agility, and body regulation. Use Chapters 10 and 11 for responsibility, repair, Gottman-style contempt patterns, and long-term bond maintenance.

The coach should never expose this routing as backend machinery. It should simply sound like it understood the situation and chose the right lens.

Research Backing

The guidebook is informed by cross-cultural mate-preference research, stated-versus-revealed preference work, sexual-regret and casual-sex research, orgasm-gap research, female intrasexual competition research, marriage and fertility trend data, online dating surveys, antidepressant-use trend data, emotion-regulation research, social-media and mental-health commentary, and Gottman repair research. These sources are used to support broad patterns, not to diagnose any individual person.

Important research anchors include work by David Buss, Walter and colleagues, Conroy-Beam, Clark and Hatfield, Tracy Vaillancourt, Dani Sulikowski, Aanchal Sharma, Steven Arnocky, Schmitt and colleagues, Weisberg and colleagues, Zhana Vrangalova, Kennair, Bendixen, Wesche, Andrejek, Piemonte, Rosenfeld, Ueda, Harris, Susan David, Lisa Feldman Barrett, Sonja Lyubomirsky, and John and Julie Gottman, alongside public demographic summaries from the U.S. Census Bureau, CDC/NCHS, Pew Research Center, Gallup, and the FDA.

How This Becomes Coaching

The app should turn the guide into plain-English decisions: selection, reciprocity, sexual pacing, peer pressure, gatekeeping, information diet, public respect, digital loyalty, behavior change, repair, and grounding. The coach should explain which lens it is using in normal language instead of exposing internal card names, raw links, or backend labels.

The coaching voice should also inherit the women's guide's best structural habit: begin by naming the user's actual situation in ordinary language. Then give one clean read, one next move, one thing to avoid, and one piece of evidence to watch. If the prompt is about a woman choosing a man, do not drift into male-centered pursuit advice. If the prompt is about a man trying to understand a woman, do not reduce the answer to flattery, sex, or reassurance. If the prompt is about long-term repair, do not stop at feelings; translate the issue into the next repeatable behavior.